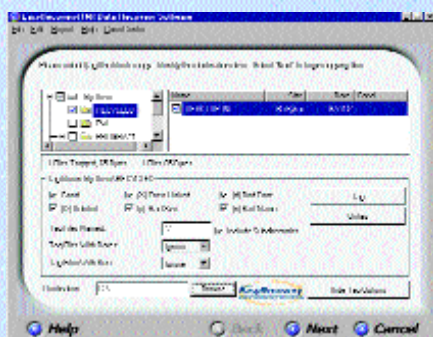


finds on the disk, but not in the FAT. It also shows the chances of recovery. If it says Poor, it means that some parts of the file have been overwritten and will not be recovered correctly. If the condition is stated as Good, the file will be recovered correctly in most cases. Select the files you want to recover and click Undelete.

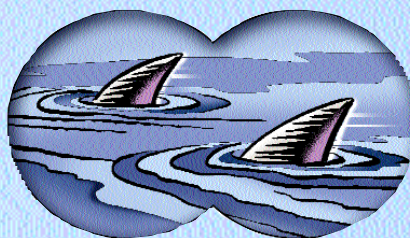
If your hard disk got formatted accidentally or you realise later that you need some data from it, the chances of recovering the data would be much lesser, but not impossible. A Quick Format affords a higher chance of recovery than a Full Format.

Easy Recovery from Ontrack (www.ontrack.com) is a very good software for recovering from such disasters. Using Easy Recovery is pretty simple. The software starts with a wizard that guides you through the data recovery steps. Click Next and the disks on the computer and partitions on them will be listed. Select the partition that you want to recover files from and click Next. You will now get a confirmation of your selection and you can optionally click Advanced to further configure the software. On clicking Next, the software will start scanning the drive for deleted files and list them in an Explorer-like interface. Check the ones you want to recover, select a destination folder and click Next. You will be notified when all files are recovered.



Easy Recovery displays deleted files that can be recovered

As we have seen, using Easy Recovery is pretty simple, but it runs under Windows. If your hard disk fails, you can attach it to another Windows machine to recover data, but this may not always be possible. The software allows you to make floppy disks with the software, so that it can also be run without Windows. Just boot from a Windows Startup Disk and run the software. This means that you should have the disk handy though—as with backups, create these floppies before disaster strikes and check them often for integrity.



Secure your data

Thieves are everywhere. It's not just your money they may be after. Your business plans, profit projects, even your address book can mean a lot to some people. Recent worms have been known to send out lists of e-mail addresses to the developers who use them to send out spam. Also, pranksters and viruses can potentially destroy all your data. It becomes very important to lock up your data away from the reach of others.

Encryption

Encryption involves scrambling of data so that it becomes indecipherable until it is unscrambled again. Simply put, it is like breaking a picture into a huge jigsaw puzzle—as long as the pieces are scattered, it is impossible to figure out what the picture is. You can do the same with documents and communication, someone should get a hold of you, it would be useless they can decrypt it.

Cryptography enables you to protect sensitive information or transmit it over public, open, insecure networks so that it cannot be read by anyone except the intended recipient. One of the simplest encryption systems was developed by the Roman emperor Julius Caesar about 2000 years ago. The cipher involved replacing the alphabets in the original text by other alphabets that are a fixed number of places away. For example, A would be substituted by D, B by E, and so on. Hence the word 'LOVE' would be encrypted to 'vhfuhw'. At the most basic level, this is what encryption involves. Over the years, very complex encryption algorithms have been developed and many of them are in use today. Encryption can become a very advanced topic if you want to learn about all the different kinds of encryption and how they work. We can safely leap to just using

Encrypting your data

We will use a free software called Pretty Good Privacy, (www.pgpi.org) for encrypting files and e-mail. PGP is known to provide very secure encryption and is widely used across the globe. During installation, be sure to select the plugin for your e-mail client. On installing the program, the PGP Generation Wizard will guide you through the process of making a private key. This will be used to encrypt your e-mail. Enter your name, e-mail address, a passphrase (password) for the key, and the key will be generated. The way the public key also

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